

TERMS OF REFERENCE

Section A

Title:	Consultant Costing Specialist – Education Sector Analysis (ESA), Education Sector Plan (ESP)		
Duty Station:	Karachi - (C)	Type of Engagement:	Consultant
	New Contract		
	Education		

Work Assignment:

1. Background:

School Education Sector Plan and Roadmap for Sindh (SESP&R) 2019-2024 was developed in 2019 through collaborative efforts by Reform Support Unit (RSU), School Education and Literacy Department (SELD), Local Education Group (LEG), Finance Department, Planning & Development Department, Development Partners/ Donors, other stakeholders and UNICEF. The development process was grounded in a comprehensive Education Sector Analysis (ESA) that examined status of the basic education in Sindh - identifying key achievements, gaps, challenges and lessons learned from the implementation of the Education Sector Plan (2014-2018). Findings of the ESA led to develop a robust Education Sector Plan and Roadmap for Sindh 2019-2024 (SESP&R) which also reflected educational vision and priorities of the Government and towards the achievement of the educational targets of SDG-4 in the province of Sindh.

As SESP&R has been concluded on 31st December 2024; SELD, UNICEF and partners intend to develop the new School Education Sector Plan for Sindh 2025-2030 (Sindh ESP 2025-30) as a more robust provincial educational instrument designed to provide sound strategic directions towards the achievement of the targets of the SDG-4. Sindh ESP 2025-30 will outline coherent set of programmatic priorities, outcomes, outputs, KPIs, costing plan, implementation strategies and arrangements that are aimed to addressing the educational challenges in Sindh including out-of-school children – also building on the past successes and the recommendations of the joint review of the 2019-2024 SESP&R, outlines mitigation for the persistent challenges and caters to the needs of emerging developments in the education sector in Sindh.

Sindh ESP 2025-2030 will be guided by a high-quality ESA and will be developed in accordance with the Guidelines for Education Sector Plan Preparations by International Institute of Educational Planning – UNESCO (IIEP- UNESCO).

Key elements of ESA will include the following.

- Examination of the context of the development of the education sector in Sindh

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- Status of access and participation in education by children of Sindh as per Right to Free and Compulsory Education and interlinkages with other sub-sectors of the education sector (TVET/others) and related multi-sectors (e.g., WASH, Child Protection, Health, Nutrition/others)
- Status of the quality of teaching and learning
- Governance and management
- Equitable educational financing
- External efficiency

Sindh ESP 2025-30 will be guided by an overall vision which is strategic, holistic, evidenced-based, achievable, context-sensitive, gender-responsive and is equity-focused. Sindh ESP 2025-30 will exhibit the following.

- Human, technical, political and financial considerations in line with the findings of ESA
- Alignment with Global/National Commitments and National/Provincial Educational Policy Framework
- Challenges and emerging needs
- Goals and Objectives of the Sindh ESP 2025-30
- Strategic Directions, Priority Program Areas, and strategies (including gender and inclusion strategy)
- Costing and financing plan
- Implementation plan including main/sub-activities, units, baselines, year-wise targets
- role of the Govt/ Partners and inter-linkages the indicators of SDG-4/others SDGs
- Monitoring plan (results framework, outcomes, outputs, results, KPIs, MOVs, reporting mechanism)
- Implementation arrangements including organizational structure and capacities
- Evaluation arrangements including review/monitoring/reporting mechanism, annual review and Joint Education Sector Reviews

In consideration of the Education Emergency in Pakistan, a Multi-Sector Strategic Roadmap for OOSC/A was recently developed. ESP will take stock of strategic aims of the Roadmap and reflect in the ESP.

Key considerations for costing of ESA and ESP (as per ESP Preparation Guidelines by IIEP-UNESCO):

- Estimated costs of the ESP will be examined at regular intervals during ESP preparation, using projections and a financial simulation model to eventually establish a reference scenario (of ESP targets and corresponding inputs) that is financially sustainable.
- Simulation model will be used to automate calculations and for ensuring the consistency of the projections made. Cost estimates and financial trade-offs will lead to the simulation of various scenarios (and corresponding policy choices).
- Above considerations will lead to rethinking and adapting the programs and policy targets until an optimum scenario is found and there is a reasonable consensus among the stakeholders.
- ESP to be developed based on the quantitative reference scenario projecting the development of the education system needs and resources requirements according to policy assumptions and targets.

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- Enrolments are projected at every level, gender-disaggregated when relevant, using access and student flow indicators.
- Human and physical resources requirements. Using target indicators and norms on the conditions of schooling (e.g. assumptions on resource use: textbooks per student ratios, class size, student/teacher ratios); ESP will simulate human resources, equipment, and infrastructure requirements.
- Necessary consultation/dialogue within SELD and external partners to be organized to identify estimation of annual plan/budgets and on-budget and off-budget amounts.

2. Work Assignment: Scope of Work:

ESA, ESP Costing Specialist Consultant will collaborate with SELD/Departments, Partners, UNICEF/other related stakeholders as well as other consultants to collect authentic unit costs, carry out cost analysis, produce related projections/ simulation model and provide disaggregated costs related to all cost elements of ESA and ESP.

ESA, ESP Costing Specialist Consultant will perform following specific tasks:

Taks-1: Collect authentic unit costs, carry out cost analysis, produce related projections/ simulation models and provide disaggregated costs related to all cost elements of ESA and ESP.

Sub-tasks 1.1: Develop/implement engagement plan with stakeholders for obtaining costs of all cost elements of ESA and ESP from SELD/Finance Department, P&DD/other Departments/external partners etc.

Sub-task 1.2: Provide unit cost, disaggregated and cumulative costs of relevant components of ESA and ESP in required formats including tabulation/graphics/ comparative analysis and others related. Cost Implementation Plan of ESP must be comprehensive and in line with IEP-UNESCO's costing framework, which recommends breaking costs into a) capital expenditures (infrastructure, ICT investments, equipment) b) recurrent expenditures (teacher salaries, maintenance, administrative costs), and c) programmatic expenditures (curriculum reforms, teacher training, inclusive education initiatives).

Sub-task 1.3: Provide projections of cost elements of ESP as unit costs, disaggregated/cumulative costs including related to gender equity indicators, indicators related to marginalized groups, OOSC, children with disabilities and under cross-sectoral thematic areas in required formats including tabulation/graphics/ comparative analysis and others related

Sub-task 1.4: Develop financial simulation models to project overall costs under different scenarios (including scenario planning for different funding levels i.e., low, medium, high investment scenarios), and a contingency fund mechanism to address unforeseen financial challenges.

Sub-task 1.5: Compare projected costs with available funding to identify any shortfall and propose strategies to address funding gaps such as reallocating resources or seeking additional funding.

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Sub-task 1.6: Propose establishing a mechanism for ongoing monitoring of expenditures & progress towards targets to be integrated in to ESP.

Sub-task 1.7: Integrated authentic, reliable and complete costs in the costed implementation plan of ESP 2025-30 in alignment with GPE's ESP financing guidelines including details regarding a) domestic financing strategies (budget reallocations, increased education share in GDP) b) external financing mechanisms (donor funding, public-private partnerships), and c) innovative financing (education bonds, results-based financing).

Sub-task 1.8: Submit a brief high-quality end-of-assignment report comprised on the processes completed i.e., what, how, when, collaborations, results achieved, limitations and any recommendations for the future.

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Section B

Work Assignment Expected Results			
Tasks/Milestone:	Deliverables/Outputs:	Delivery Deadline	¹ Estimate Budget
Taks-1: Collect authentic unit costs, carry out cost analysis, produce related projections/ simulation modeling and provide disaggregated costs related to all cost elements of ESA and ESP. Sub-tasks 1.1: Develop/implement engagement plan with the stakeholders for obtaining costs of all cost elements of ESA and ESP from SELD/Finance Department, P&DD/others Departments/ external partners etc. Sub-task 1.2: Provide unit cost, disaggregated and cumulative costs of relevant components of ESA and ESP in required formats including tabulation/graphics/ comparative analysis and others related. Cost Implementation Plan of ESP must be comprehensive and in line with IEP- UNESCO's costing framework, which recommends breaking costs into a) capital expenditures (infrastructure, ICT investments, equipment) b) recurrent expenditures (teacher salaries, maintenance, administrative costs), and c) programmatic expenditures (curriculum reforms, teacher training, inclusive education initiatives).	Deliverable 1.1: Submit draft and final engagement plan & brief report on consultative meetings held Deliverable 1.2: Provide draft and final datasets in required format	30th April 2025	30% of total fee
Sub-task 1.3: Provide projections of cost elements of ESP as unit costs, disaggregated/cumulative costs	Deliverable 1.3 & 1.4: Provide draft and final report on the projections and simulation	20th May 2025	40% of total fee

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including related to gender equity indicators, indicators related to marginalized groups, OOSC, children with disabilities and under cross-sectoral thematic areas in required formats including tabulation/graphics/ comparative analysis and others related Sub-task 1.4: Develop financial simulation models to project overall costs under different scenarios Sub-task 1.5: Compare projected costs with available funding to identify any shortfall, and propose strategies to address funding gaps, such as reallocating resources or seeking additional funding Sub-task 1.6: Propose establishing a mechanism for ongoing monitoring of expenditures & progress towards targets to be integrated into ESP	models in required format Deliverable 1.5: Draft and final strategy to address funding shortfall Deliverable 1.6: Draft and final note on proposed mechanism for monitoring of expenditures & progress towards targets		
Sub-task 1.7: Integrated authentic, reliable and complete costs in the costed implementation plan of ESP 2025-30 in alignment with GPE's ESP financing guidelines including details regarding a) domestic financing strategies (budget reallocations, increased education share in GDP) b) external financing mechanisms (donor funding, public-private partnerships), and c) innovative financing (education bonds, results-based financing). Sub-task 1.8: Submit a brief high-quality end-of-assignment report comprised on the processes completed i.e., what, how,	Deliverable 1.7: Draft and final costed implementation plan of ESP 2025-30 Deliverable 1.8: Draft and final end-of-assignment report	30th July 2025	30% of total fee

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when, collaborations, results achieved, limitations and any recommendations for the future.			